reiterate our complete and dedicated commitment to the decisions taken by Ratan [Tata] over the change in leadership of Tata Sons Ltd.'

On the same day, the TELCO Workers' Union also wrote a letter to the Tata Motors' plant head in Jamshedpur, expressing their support for Ratan, and called him 'another great leader'. In the letter, they cited one of his favourite quotes: 'If you want to walk fast, walk alone, but if you want to walk far, walk together'.

Just as in the case of Tata Chemicals and Tata Steel, Wadia got the six independent directors of Tata Motors to meet separately, this time before the full board meeting, and they issued a statement to the stock exchanges. It supported Mistry and stated that the chairman and the management had executed the decisions taken by the board. It also stated that all decisions were 'unanimous'.

It was reported that some of the independent directors had objected to any statement affirming unequivocal support to Mistry and to naming him like in the IHCL statement. In the aggregation, the statement of the automobile giant was the weakest of the three issued by Tata companies in support of Mistry. On his performance, the IHCL statement said that the independent directors 'praised' and 'unanimously expressed their full confidence in the Chairman, Cyrus Mistry', and that of Tata Chemicals said that the independent directors 'unanimously affirmed their confidence in the Board, its Chairman and the management'. It had omitted naming Mistry when the board expressed its confidence in the management. It was only to be understood that he was a part of the management just as other senior functionaries like the MD are.

The next day, 15 November, saw more drama unfold. On that day, the TGBL board met for two hours to discuss the second quarter results of the company. The issue pertaining to Mistry's role as chairman was taken up as part of other agenda. At the board meeting, TGBL replaced Mistry as its chairman by a majority vote and appointed Harish Bhat in his place. The decision was communicated to the stock exchanges. Due to a technical problem, however, the board proceedings could not be recorded—a statutory requirement when any member participates through a video link. This rendered the proceedings technically illegal. The appointment of Harish Bhat was especially targeted by Mistry for a scathing attack. He contended that the communication to the stock exchanges was an illegal act. Mistry followed this up with a letter to the company secretary questioning